Institution: British Museum
Registration Number: 2006,0331.12
Fabric: Corinthian ceramic (buff clay)
Shape: Amphora, Type Corinthian B
Attribution: Corinthian workshop (unidentified)
Date: Archaic Period; late 6th century BCE
Dimensions: D. 42cm; H. 51.40cm
Provenance: Unknown

Fabric, Technique, Shape & Condition Wheel-thrown Corinthian amphora of type B, in buff-coloured clay of fine texture. The vessel has a broad body, thickened and rounded rim, and vertical handles rising from the shoulder to the neck, with a truncated foot.[1] An echinoid band is preserved on the rim.

The surface is unglazed and undecorated. Fire clouds are visible on the upper body, likely a result of uneven kiln conditions (Fig.1). The vessel is largely intact, with evidence of surface wear and water damage. No major structural losses are present.

Iconography The vessel is undecorated, with no figural or painted ornament. Apart from the echinoid band at the rim, no additional decorative elements or stamped marks are visible.

Figure 1. Transport amphora (Corinthian Type B), late 6th century BCE. British Museum, London. Accession no. 2006,0331.12. Image © The Trustees of the British Museum.

Attribution & Dating Attributed broadly to a Corinthian workshop on the basis of fabric, form, and typology. The type B amphora, with its broad proportions and standardised profile, is characteristic of Corinthian ceramic production in the later Archaic period.[2]

The absence of painted decoration and the utilitarian finish distinguish this example from contemporary figured wares, aligning it instead with transport amphorae intended for storage and distribution. Such vessels are commonly associated with the movement of liquids, particularly wine, within Mediterranean trade networks.[3] A date in the late 6th century is consistent with the established production of Corinthian Type B amphorae of this form.

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[1] University of Toronto. "Corinthian Amphora (CorAB 92)." Accessed Mar 29, 2026, https://amphoras.artsci.utoronto.ca/corab92.htm.

[2] Koehler, Carolyn G. "A Brief Typology and Chronology of Corinthian Transport Amphoras." Originally published in *Greek Amphoras*, edited by V.I. Kats and S.Iu. Monakhov. Saratov, 1992. Reproduced in *The AMPHORAS Project*, University of Toronto. Accessed Mar 23. https://amphoras.artsci.utoronto.ca/corab92.htm.

[3] Ibid.

Works Cited

British Museum. “Transport Amphora (Corinthian Type B).” Collection online. Accessed Mar 20, 2026. https://www.britishmuseum.org/collection/object/G_2006-0331-12.

Koehler, Carolyn G. "A Brief Typology and Chronology of Corinthian Transport Amphoras." Originally published in *Greek Amphoras*, edited by V.I. Kats and S.Iu. Monakhov. Saratov, 1992. Reproduced in *The AMPHORAS Project*, University of Toronto. Accessed Mar 23. https://amphoras.artsci.utoronto.ca/corab92.htm.

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